

1st Private Development Prerelease	September 2015
2nd Private Development Prerelease	October 2015
3rd Private Development Prerelease	November 2015
4th Private Development Prerelease	January 2018

P?S/8 PTUTIL

User Guide

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As of January 2018, the PTUTIL utility is still being tested in stages; certain routines still need to be added to make an entire functioning utility, as a bottom-up approach is being used due to the complexity of certain of the options. As has been used elsewhere, some functions started out as dummy routines merely to avoid assembly errors; temporarily alternate routines are being used to confirm the completed sections actually work as intended.

For example, instead of outputting to some combination of P?S/8 output files, the characters slated for output (past internal filters and conversions) are merely displayed on the console device. This allows confirmation that all lower-level routines are functioning properly. Certain program bugs to date were detected and fixed while debugging PTUTIL on the PEPS for windows SIMH simulator package.

Currently, there is no support for creating output from the contents of P?S/8 text files; in the scheme of things, this is a lower-priority function, and easier to debug (at least in theory). Certain internal design considerations (such as overall program size) will not be impacted by output design as much as all of the input parameters which can severely impact coding techniques. Note: At all costs, the program needs to be complete as loaded into memory in 4K. The current operating mode will be determined by carefully designed once-only initialization code processing the passed command-line switches. As such, certain memory areas must be carefully chosen to act as buffers instead of code pages after initialization. If overlays are required, the program will become unwieldy and incompatible with the R (or RU{n}) % (or R [or RU{n}] \$) program execution methods; this would cause the addition of PTUTIL to existing systems too difficult for most beginners.

This notice will be removed when a nominally complete program is being tested prior to release.

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